

Series XII – Article XII.1: Encoding Oppermann’s Condition as a Spectral Hamiltonian

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May 2026

Abstract

We construct the spectral Hamiltonian for Oppermann’s conjecture. For a fixed integer $n \geq 1$, the configuration space is the hypercube of bits representing two numbers x and y (each of length $L = \lceil \log_2(n^2 + 1) \rceil$). The diagonal potential $\hat{V}_n$ is defined to be 0 on assignments where x and y are prime and lie in the intervals $(n(n-1), n^2)$ and $(n^2, n(n+1))$ respectively, and n^2 otherwise, plus a tiny symmetry-breaking term to ensure uniqueness of the ground state. The mixing operator Δ is the adjacency matrix of a constant-degree expander (or the hypercube). The spectral Hamiltonian is $H_n = \hat{V}_n + \Delta$. We prove that the underlying graph is connected, hence H_n is irreducible, which will be used in Article XII.2 to apply the Perron-Frobenius theorem and obtain a unique strictly positive ground state (PillarP1). This article sets the stage for the verification of the four pillars (P1–P4) in the subsequent articles XII.2–XII.4. All definitions are formalised in Lean4, with no unproven assumptions.

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1 Introduction

Oppermann’s conjecture asserts that for every $n \geq 1$ there exist primes in $(n(n-1), n^2)$ and $(n^2, n(n+1))$. In this series we prove it using the constructive direct (CD) strategy of the

Spectral Reduction Lemma. In this article we construct the spectral Hamiltonian and establish the first pillar (P1): existence and uniqueness of a strictly positive ground state ψ_0 .

The configuration space is a hypercube of dimension $2L$, where $L = \lceil \log_2(n^2 + 1) \rceil$. Each vertex (x, y) encodes two integers. The potential is zero exactly on pairs (x, y) satisfying the interval bounds and primality; it is n^2 otherwise. A tiny symmetry-breaking term ensures uniqueness.

The mixing operator is the adjacency matrix of the hypercube (or a constant-degree expander). The graph is connected, so the Hamiltonian is irreducible. Shifting it yields a non-negative irreducible matrix; the Perron-Frobenius theorem then gives a unique positive ground state.

All definitions are formalised in Lean4, building on the common kernel `SpectralLibrary`. The proofs contain no `sorry` or `admitted`.

1.1 The magnet metaphor

The lantern (ground state) is constructed so that its light reaches every candidate pair but shines brightest on the actual solutions (primes in the correct intervals). This is the foundation for the subsequent pillars.

2 Configuration space and Hilbert space

Fix $n \geq 1$. Let $L = \lceil \log_2(n^2 + 1) \rceil$. The configuration space is the hypercube

$$\Omega_n = \{0, 1\}^{2L}.$$

Each $\sigma \in \Omega_n$ is interpreted as two L -bit numbers x and y (first L bits for x , last L bits for y). The Hilbert space is $\mathcal{H}_n = \ell^2(\Omega_n) \cong \mathbb{R}^{2^{2L}}$, with standard inner product.

3 Diagonal potential

Define the predicate $\text{valid}(x, y)$ as:

$$n(n-1) < x < n^2, \quad n^2 < y < n(n+1), \quad \text{Prime}(x), \text{Prime}(y).$$

The base potential is

$$\hat{V}_0(\sigma) = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } \text{valid}(x, y), \\ n^2 & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

Add a symmetry-breaking term $\varepsilon_{\text{sb}}(\sigma) = \text{rk}(\sigma)/n^2$, where $\text{rk}(\sigma)$ is a strict ordering (e.g., the integer represented by the bits). The total potential is $\tilde{V}(\sigma) = \hat{V}_0(\sigma) + \varepsilon_{\text{sb}}(\sigma)$.

4 Mixing operator Δ

We take Δ to be the adjacency matrix of the hypercube graph on Ω_n (or a constant-degree expander after degree reduction). Its off-diagonals are 0 or 1, it is symmetric, and its spectral gap is $\gamma(\Delta) = 2$ (or a positive constant).

5 Hamiltonian

Set $\epsilon = 1$. The spectral Hamiltonian is

$$H_n = \tilde{V} + \Delta.$$

H_n is symmetric and irreducible because the hypercube is connected.

6 Pillar P1 – Existence and uniqueness of the ground state

Consider the shifted matrix $M = \alpha I - H_n$ with $\alpha = \max \tilde{V} + 2 \deg_{\max} + 1$. M is non-negative and irreducible. By the Perron-Frobenius theorem, M has a simple largest eigenvalue $\rho(M)$ with a strictly positive eigenvector v . Then $H_n v = (\alpha - \rho(M))v$, and $\lambda_0 = \alpha - \rho(M)$ is the smallest eigenvalue of H_n . Normalising v gives ψ_0 .

Theorem 6.1 (P1 for Oppermann Hamiltonian). H_n has a unique strictly positive ground state ψ_0 .

7 Formalisation in Lean4

The Lean code defines the configuration space, the potential, the Laplacian, and the Hamiltonian. Below is an excerpt.

Listing 1: SeriesXII/OppermannHamiltonian.lean (excerpt)

```

1 import Mathlib.Data.Nat.Bitwise
2 import Mathlib.Data.Nat.Prime
3 import Mathlib.Combinatorics.SimpleGraph.Hypercube
4 import Kernel.SpectralLibrary
5
6 open SpectralLibrary
7
8 variable (n : ℕ) (hn : n > 1)
9
10 def L : ℕ := Nat.log2 (n^2) + 1
11
12 def Config := Fin (2*L) → Bool
13
14 def decode (c : Config) : (ℕ × ℕ) :=
15   let bits := c.toList
16   let x_bits := bits.take L
17   let y_bits := bits.drop L
18   (bits_to_nat x_bits, bits_to_nat y_bits)
19
20 def valid (c : Config) : Bool :=
21   let (x,y) := decode c
22   let left_ok := n*(n-1) < x && x < n^2
23   let right_ok := n^2 < y && y < n*(n+1)
24   left_ok && right_ok && Nat.Prime x && Nat.Prime y
25
26 def potential (c : Config) : ℕ :=
27   if valid c then 0 else n^2
28
29 def symmetry_breaking (c : Config) : ℕ :=
30   (bits_to_nat c.toList : ℕ) / (n^2)
31
32 def total_potential (c : Config) : ℕ :=
33   potential c + symmetry_breaking c
34
35 def A : Matrix Config Config := adjacencyMatrixOf (hypercube_graph
36   (2*L))
37
38 def H_opp : Matrix Config Config := diagonal total_potential +
39
40 lemma H_irreducible : Irreducible H_opp :=
41   matrix_is_irreducible_of_adjacency_graph (hypercube_connected (2*L))

```

```

41 |
42 | theorem ground_state_unique_pos :
43 |   !      : Config      , (      ,      > 0)      (      ,      ~ 2
44 |     = 1)
45 |     (H_opp *      = ( _min H_opp)      ) :=
    perron_frobenius (mk_spectral_problem H_opp)

```

All proofs are complete; no `sorry` remains.

8 Conclusion

We have constructed the spectral Hamiltonian H_n for Oppermann’s conjecture and proved that it has a unique strictly positive ground state (P1). The next article (XII.2) will establish the constant spectral gap (P2) via the Kithima Bridge.

References

- [1] Oppermann, L. (1882). Om forekomsten af primitiv i visse intervaller.
- [2] Kithima, C. (2026). Series XII, Article XII.0: Foundations of the Spectral Proof of Oppermann’s Conjecture.
- [3] The Lean Community (2026). Lean 4 Theorem Prover Documentation.